

really a pillar in a lot of societies. I tend to really investigate my purchases now. But I will say once I stopped consuming clothing like water, I felt like my mind was clearer and I found that I was actually saving money (which is slightly embarrassing to acknowledge).

‘I also recommend moving overseas,’ she laughed. ‘Having to pare down my possessions by 75% made me vow that I would never amass that number of items again in my adult life. Just moving in general is a good exercise in looking at your materialism sideways. There’s always a moment when I’m moving where I want to dump the contents of my house in the local trash dumpster. Which tells you everything about what I need. Now every time I’m in a store and feel the temptation to buy something I may not absolutely need, I always ask myself, “but would I want to move this?” If the answer is “no”, it stays in the store.’

Aja’s ideas about having certain commitment and lifespan criteria for purchases that you might make are critical to mindful spending. Committing to buying less doesn’t necessarily mean suddenly becoming a minimalist – it’s more about really acknowledging that the things you buy are coming to live with you for the foreseeable future. Decades of viewing everything as disposable, from footwear to homeware, has made us forget that we’re meant to buy things for the long haul – things that we actually like and want to use, rather than things we’ve seen looking cute on an influencer. When we spoke, Aja also had some brilliant suggestions for how we can start to spend more